V10 SELF-MONITORING | O (MAX : 1 PT)

Intent : Promote self-awareness of health behaviors and health metrics through wearable technology.

Summary : This WELL feature requires projects to provide or subsidize wearables that can monitor physical activity and health behaviors over time.

Issue : Much of what we understand about physical activity's relationship to health and well-being is derived from studies that utilize self-reported measures of physical activity. [1] Evidence suggests that self-reported measures tend to overestimate actual physical activity behaviors.[2]

Solutions : Objective, accelerometer-based tools that track physical activity have proliferated the marketplace.[3–5] Estimates from 2016 indicate 33% of people across 16 countries (including 20,000 individuals) used a wearable or app to track physical activity and health parameters.[3,6,7] In addition, an estimated 44.5% of employers leverage them in strategic planning of wellness programs.[8] Evidence from a systematic review conducted by the U.S. Centers for Disease Control and Prevention shows that, particularly when paired with coaching and counseling, technology tools can have a positive impact on recording reliable data and improving health outcomes.[9] In a comprehensive review led by the U.S. Physical Activity Guidelines Committee, researchers found evidence that wearable activity monitors, including simple step counters, when paired with goal-setting, were effective at increasing physical activity.[10] In a meta-analysis of several randomized controlled trials, use of a step counter paired with a step goal significantly reduced sedentary time among adults.[11] Projects should consider privacy and data security among users when they are vetting technologies to recommend to their occupants, and when projects may have access to users' wearable data.

PART 1 PROVIDE SELF-MONITORING TOOLS (MAX : 1 PT)

For All Spaces:

The project or organization provides devices (e.g., wearable fitness tracker) to all eligible employees that meet the following requirements:

a. Available at no cost or subsidized by at least 50%.

b. Allow users to monitor their own metrics over time (i.e., provides a dashboard where individual metrics are aggregated).

c. Measure at least two physical activity metrics (e.g., steps, floors climbed, activity minutes).

d. Measure at least one additional health behavior (e.g., mindfulness practice, sleep).

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